

ABOUT ME

Current Pre-Doctoral Fellow at UChicago Booth in Quantitative Marketing with Professor Andreas Kraft.
Graduated with M.S. in Data Science from The University of Chicago with a 4.0 GPA.
Earned bachelor's degrees in Economics, Finance, and History as a triple major at The Ohio State University.
Experienced in teaching roles across STEM fields, including Statistics.
Recipient of the Pace Setters Award.

PUBLICATIONS

When to Think Fast and Slow? AMOR: Adaptive Entropy Gate for Hybrid Models
Under review · ICLR 2027

Conceptizer: Next-Token Prediction Is Not All You Need
To be submitted · ACL Rolling Review

Can You Tell a Smile from a Veil? How Buyers Respond to AI Written Listings in Government Auctions
Working paper · preprint forthcoming

Do AIs Dream of Electric Butterflies? Benchmarking LLM Consciousness via Theory-Grounded Self-Reports
PsyArXiv preprint · Oct 2025

SCENE: Evaluating Explainable AI Techniques Using Soft Counterfactuals
arXiv preprint · Aug 2024

LINKS

Personal Website:
haoranzhengraul.github.io

LinkedIn Profile:
linkedin.com/in/haoran-zheng-04a9551ba

HAORAN ZHENG

AI RESEARCHER

haoranzheng@uchicago.edu
Chicago, IL, USA

WORK EXPERIENCE

Dr. Andreas Kraft
The University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Jun 2025 – Present

Research Professional in Quantitative Marketing
- Working on fuel-market research and related projects, including geolocating gas stations relative to highways, designing a simulated eBay-style marketplace, finding new datasets for potential research, and cleaning, labeling and analyzing large-scale data.

Dr. Nicholas Epley
The University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

Research Assistant in Behavioral Science
- Collaborated closely with Dr. Nicholas Epley and Yale PhD candidate Yin Li on "The Multicultural Study," focusing on cross-cultural perceptions of beliefs and preferences.

Mindworks Lab
The University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Apr 2024 – Jun 2025

Research Specialist in Behavioral Science
- Examined frontier behavioral science research on prospect theory and diminishing sensitivity.
- Co-managed studies and collected data for Dr. Alexander Todorov and Dr. Sarah Sebo.

Dr. Christopher Reed
The Ohio State University
Apr 2024 – May 2025

Research Assistant in History
- Applied modern NLP techniques and the SCENE method to traditional history research.
- Identified the significance of previously unseen historical documents.

China Automotive Systems
NASDAQ: CAAS
May 2021 – May 2023

Financial Analyst
- Conducted financial analysis and modeling for automotive industry applications.

The Ohio State University
Feb 2021 – May 2022

Lead Teaching Assistant for Statistics 2320
- Taught two weekly recitations for 65 students each, focusing on statistical concepts and analytical tools (R).
- Developed customized review notes and visual aids for 900+ enrolled students each semester.

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago
Chicago, IL
2024

Master of Science in Data Science (GPA 4.0/4.0)
- Thesis: "Demystifying the Black Box: Evaluations of Explainable AI Techniques in NLP" (Advisor: Dr. Utku Pamuksuz).

The Ohio State University
Columbus, OH
2022

Bachelor of Science in Economics
- Triple major in Economics (GPA 3.9/4.0), Finance (GPA 3.8/4.0), and History (GPA 3.8/4.0).

ACTIVITIES

- Soccer: played for the Columbus Crew (Major League Soccer) reserve team, 2016–17 season.
- E-sports: competed professionally in Pro Evolution Soccer 2017; ranked 45th on the American continental server; semifinalist at the US National Championship; YouTube channel "FlyinGodzilla."
- Muay Thai & kickboxing: sanctioned bouts (1–1 record).
- Photography.